

What was a gladiator?

Two thousand years ago, in Roman cities, crowds gathered to be entertained by watching people fight. The fighters were called gladiators, and sometimes they fought to the death. There were more than 20 types of gladiator, who fought with different weapons.

Animals, too!

Before the gladiators stepped into the arena, the crowds were entertained by trained hunters who would fight animals such as lions and wolves.



Short sword:

Some gladiators fought with a short, curved sword called a sica.

A large, detailed illustration of a gladiator in Roman armor, including a blue helmet with a crest, a blue tunic, and a blue skirt. He is holding a short, curved sword (sica) in his right hand. A dotted line with an arrow points from the text 'Short sword:' to the sword. Another dotted line with an arrow points from the text 'The first gladiators were prisoners from countries invaded by the Roman army.' to the gladiator's leg.

The first gladiators were prisoners from countries invaded by the Roman army.